

Ecclesiastical Latin

EL-III.7: Graduals, Alleluias, Tracts, and Sequences

Recover syntax, voice, parallelism, and responsible ellipsis from poetic and psalmic liturgical texts

Stage	Stage III — Independent Missal Reading
Prerequisite	EL-III.6 and reliable prose reconstruction
Next	EL-III.8, Prefaces and the Roman Canon

Read *EL-GUIDE: Start Here* before using this packet. Course method, pacing, source conventions, and answer protocol are stated there; this module begins with its lesson and assumes previously taught terms.

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Part I

Lesson

CHAPTER 1

Graduals, Alleluias, Tracts, and Sequences

On completing this unit, you can:

- read psalmic parallelism without forcing every colon into prose syntax;
- restore only ellipses demanded by grammar;
- recognize poetic word order, alternate perfect endings, and predicative participles;
- paraphrase a chant unit in simple Latin before making an English version.

Chant texts are short, but they are not necessarily easy. A Gradual or Tract may excerpt distant psalm verses, omit a repeated subject, or coordinate clauses by rhythm rather than conjunction. A sequence adds rhyme, compressed images, and occasionally archaic forms. Treat the verse marker as a performance marker, not always a syntactic boundary.

In this volume a **chant unit** is the textual unit assigned to one chant position, even when it draws on nonadjacent source verses. A **Gradual** is the chant after the Lesson, an **Alleluia** is the alleluiatic chant before the Gospel, and a **Tract** takes the corresponding pre-Gospel place in specified non-alleluiatic Masses. A **Sequence** is an extended strophic text placed before the Gospel in the Masses to which the 1962 Missal assigns one, after the Alleluia or Tract as applicable. These liturgical definitions do not imply that all four share one poetic syntax.

Parallelism arranges corresponding members so that their likeness, contrast, or progression is perceptible. A **colon** is one such sense-and- rhythm member of a verse; punctuation may mark it, but a colon need not be an independent clause. **Poetic word order** separates or reorders related elements for pattern or emphasis while leaving their inflections and dependencies intact.

1.1 Psalmic parallelism

Universi, qui te exspectant, non confundentur, Domine. V. Vias tuas, Domine, notas fac mihi: et semitas tuas edoce me.

Source: *Missale Romanum* (1962), Dominica I Adventus, Graduale (Ps. 24:3–4).

Substantial *universi* is modified by *qui te exspectant* and is subject of passive *confundentur*. The next verse balances *vias tuas* with *semitas tuas*. In *notas fac mihi*, *notas* is predicate accusative with *vias*; *mihi* is dative. The second imperative *edoce* takes *me* and may take the thing taught as accusative. Do not supply a new divine subject between the parallel members.

The Alleluia of the same Mass reads:

Ostende nobis, Domine, misericordiam tuam: et salutare tuum da nobis.

Source: *Missale Romanum* (1962), Dominica I Adventus, Alleluia (Ps. 84:8).

The two imperatives reverse object and recipient: *nobis ... misericordiam* then *salutare ... nobis*. Neuter substantial *salutare* means the saving help manifested by God; it is not an infinitive.

1.2 The sustained Tract

Qui habitat in adiutorio Altissimi, in protectione Dei cæli commorabitur. V. Dicet Domino: Susceptor meus es tu, et refugium meum.

Source: *Missale Romanum* (1962), Dominica I in Quadragesima, Tractus (Ps. 90:1–2).

Substantial *qui* supplies the subject of future *commorabitur*. The two *in* phrases use ablatives and form a parallel description of dwelling. Future *dicet* takes dative *Domino*; the quoted sentence has *tu* as subject and *susceptor meus* and *refugium meum* as predicate nominatives. The long Tract continues by changing persons and speakers; mark those changes rather than assuming a single uninterrupted voice.

1.3 Sequence compression

Victimæ paschali laudes immolent Christiani. Agnus redemit oves: Christus innocens Patri reconciliavit peccatores.

Source: *Missale Romanum* (1962), Dominica Resurrectionis, Sequentia *Victimæ paschali laudes*.

immolent is jussive subjunctive; *Christiani* is its subject, *laudes* its object, and *Victimæ paschali* dative recipient. The next two clauses use stark nominative–verb–object patterns. Dative *Patri* belongs with *reconciliavit*; *Christus innocens* and the sacrificial *Agnus* have the same referent and form a theological parallel, but they are the distinct subjects of *reconciliavit* and *redemit*, respectively.

Later the sequence says:

Mors et vita duello conflixere mirando: dux vitæ mortuus regnat vivus.

conflixere is third-person plural perfect with the alternative ending *-ere* for *-erunt*; it is not a syncopated form. *duello mirando* is ablative of the wondrous combat. *mortuus* and *vivus* are predicative: the dead leader of life reigns living. Prose order helps—*dux vitæ, mortuus, vivus regnat*—but the crossed poetic order makes death and living meet in one line.

A **third-person plural perfect in *-ere*** uses an inherited alternative to the ending *-erunt*; the two endings have the same person, number, tense, voice, and mood. A **predicative** adjective or participle states a condition of a subject or object within the verbal assertion. Thus *mortuus* and *vivus* tell how the leader stands in relation to *regnat*, not just which leader is meant.

1.4 A responsible ellipsis ledger

For every supplied word write one of three labels:

- G** grammatically required, as an implicit subject contained in a verb;
- P** supplied from a strict parallel member;
- I** interpretive, helpful for sense but not recoverable as exact wording.

Only G and carefully justified P supplies belong in a clause reconstruction. An I supply may appear in commentary but never inside the Latin quotation.

Part II

Practice

CHAPTER 1

Transfer, retrieval, and application

1.1 Psalmic parallelism — transfer practice

Connection. Parallel members may repeat, develop, contrast, or complete one another while preserving distinct syntax.

Transfer task. Make a two-column map of the lesson's first parallel pair: align corresponding heads, verbs, objects, and modifiers, then name the semantic relation.

Retrieval check. Identify one repeated feature and one grammatical difference.

1.2 The sustained Tract — transfer practice

Connection. A longer chant requires a speaker-and-addressee ledger across verse boundaries.

Transfer task. On the lesson's Tract selection, mark every finite verb and pronoun, then record speaker, addressee, and antecedent for each verse unit.

Retrieval check. State when a verse mark may not be treated as a sentence boundary.

1.3 Sequence compression — transfer practice

Connection. Rhyme and balanced short lines can separate words that remain bound by case, agreement, or government.

Transfer task. Choose one stanza already printed in the lesson and present it in three forms: printed order, dependency groups, and neutral prose scaffold.

Retrieval check. Name one effect lost in the neutral scaffold.

1.4 A responsible ellipsis ledger — transfer practice

Connection. A supply is a claim with an evidence class, not invisible editorial repair.

Transfer task. Record three possible supplies from the selected worksheets, label each G, P, or I, and reject one tempting but unnecessary addition.

Retrieval check. Give the minimum evidence required for a grammatical supply.

Part III

Worksheets

CHAPTER 1

Unit III.7: Graduals, Alleluias, Tracts, and Sequences

Worksheet III.25 — Variant A

Worksheet ID: III.25

Focus: Psalmic parallelism

Use: Treat verse markers as performance marks first.

1. **Text:** *Universi, qui te expectant, non confundentur, Domine. V. Vias tuas, Domine, notas fac mihi: et semitas tuas edoce me.*

Passage ID: III.25.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Map both verses and the parallel objects.

-
2. Write the second verse in analytical order.

-
3. Why is *universi* substantival rather than modifying an omitted noun that must be restored?

-
4. Classify the two occurrences of *tuas* and one *te*.

-
5. Answer in Latin: *Qui non confundentur?*

-
6. Write a two-member parallel petition modeled on *vias ... semitas*.
-

Worksheet III.28 — Variant D**Worksheet ID:** III.28**Focus:** Unseen chant audit**Use:** Keep psalm quotation and liturgical voice distinct.

1. **Text:** *Hæc dies, quam fecit Dominus: exsulemus, et lætemur in ea. Confitemini Domino, quoniam bonus: quoniam in sæculum misericordia eius.*

Passage ID: III.28.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Map relatives, exhortations, commands, and ellipsis.

-
2. Why does *ea* have feminine form?

-
3. Classify a bracketed copula after *quoniam bonus*.

-
4. Parse *confitemini*.

-
5. Answer in Latin: *Cur fideles exsultant?*

-
6. Give a lookup ledger with no more than two entries.
-

Part IV

Assessment

CHAPTER 1

Mastery assessment and record

Advance when: On an unfamiliar chant, account for every finite form, agreement link, voice, and proposed ellipsis; reconstruct dependencies without importing new content; and explain one effect of the printed parallel or displaced order.

Complete the assessment before opening the answer part. Record evidence, not confidence or elapsed time.

Evidence	First attempt	Delayed check
Date and conditions		
Worksheet ID and score		
Mastery task and result		
One recurring error family		
Correction stated as a rule		
Unseen or remediation item used		

If the criterion is met: continue to EL-III.8, Prefaces and the Roman Canon.

If it is not met: Worksheets III.26 and III.27 remain optional Tract-voice and sequence-compression practice.

Advance / remediate decision: _____ **Next review date:** _____

Reason in one complete sentence: _____

Part V

Answer Key

Open this part only after completing the assessment record. Use the comparison and alternative-answer protocol in EL-GUIDE.

CHAPTER 1

Practice models and rubrics

Psalmic parallelism — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. The model aligns forms only where morphology and syntax support the correspondence and labels the relation cautiously. Merely placing two translated lines side by side is insufficient.

The sustained Tract — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. The ledger follows grammatical persons and antecedents; a verse mark is not a sentence boundary when dependencies or a finite clause continue across it.

Sequence compression — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. All three versions retain every printed form and bracket any supply. The return note may identify repetition, rhyme, suspense, or foregrounding, but must cite exact forms.

A responsible ellipsis ledger — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. A grammatical supply is demanded by construction; a parallel supply comes from an adjacent repeated frame; an interpretive supply assists sense but is not forced. The rejected addition must be shown unnecessary to the parse.

CHAPTER 2

Unit III.7: Graduals, Alleluias, Tracts, and Sequences

Solution III.25 — Variant A

Worksheet ID: III.25

Focus: Psalmic parallelism

Use: Treat verse markers as performance marks first.

1. **Text:** *Universi, qui te expectant, non confundentur, Domine. V. Vias tuas, Domine, notas fac mihi: et semitas tuas edoce me.*

Passage ID: III.25.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Map both verses and the parallel objects.

Answer / notes: Substantival *universi* with relative *qui te expectant* is subject of future passive *confundentur*; *Domine* vocative. In the verse, imperatives *fac/edoce*; *vias/semitas* parallel objects; *notas* predicate accusative with *vias*; *mihi* dative, *me* object.

2. Write the second verse in analytical order.

Answer / model: *Domine, fac vias tuas notas mihi et edoce me semitas tuas.*

3. Why is *universi* substantival rather than modifying an omitted noun that must be restored?

Answer / model: The adjective can itself mean all persons/everyone. A noun such as *homines* may explain the sense but is an interpretive, not grammatically required, supply.

4. Classify the two occurrences of *tuas* and one *te*.

Answer / model: *tuas*: accusative feminine plural possessive adjectives agreeing with *vias/semitas*; *te*: accusative personal pronoun, object of *expectant*.

5. Answer in Latin: *Qui non confundentur?*

Answer / model: *Universi qui Dominum expectant non confundentur.*

6. Write a two-member parallel petition modeled on *vias ... semitas*.

Answer / model: Model: *Veritatem tuam ostende mihi, et legem tuam edoce me.*

Solution III.28 — Variant D

Worksheet ID: III.28

Focus: Unseen chant audit

Use: Keep psalm quotation and liturgical voice distinct.

1. **Text:** *Hæc dies, quam fecit Dominus: exsulemus, et lætemur in ea. Confitemini Domino, quoniam bonus: quoniam in sæculum misericordia eius.*

Passage ID: III.28.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Map relatives, exhortations, commands, and ellipsis.

Answer / notes: *hæc dies* begins a verbless nominal acclamation; an English “this is the day” is interpretive. Relative *quam fecit Dominus*. Hortatory *exsulemus/lætemur*, with *in ea* referring to *die*. Plural imperative *confitemini* governs dative *Domino*. Both *quoniam bonus* and *quoniam in sæculum misericordia eius* are verbless clauses; [*Dominus est*] and [*est/manet*] are interpretive paraphrases, not grammatically required supplies. Source: Dominica Resurrectionis, Graduale (Ps. 117:24, 1).

2. Why does *ea* have feminine form?

Answer / model: It refers to feminine *dies* in this fixed-day context and is ablative after *in*.

3. Classify a bracketed copula after *quoniam bonus*.

Answer / model: I: the printed clause is verbless. [*Dominus est*] can clarify the dependency or supply an English copula, but it is not required as omitted Latin text.

4. Parse *confitemini*.

Answer / model: Second plural present imperative deponent of *confiteor*, *confiteri*, *confessus sum*; it governs dative *Domino*.

5. Answer in Latin: *Cur fideles exsultant?*

Answer / model: *Exsultant quia hæc est dies quam Dominus fecit et quia misericordia eius in sæculum manet.*

6. Give a lookup ledger with no more than two entries.

Answer / model: A defensible reader may need *confiteor* for its deponent form/government and *sæculum* for the idiom *in sæculum*. Endings and pronoun reference require no dictionary.

Part VI

Scope and Sources

CHAPTER 1

Scope and Qualifications

1.1 Packet boundary

This is module EL-III.7, *Graduals, Alleluias, Tracts, and Sequences*, in Triptych's print-first Ecclesiastical Latin curriculum. It imports one authoritative lesson, transfer practice for its internal submodules, two selected worksheets, one local mastery assessment, and matching solutions. This packet reads text, not chant notation or performance practice.

The unprinted worksheet variants remain course-owned extension material; their omission is intentional and is not a claim that the module exhausts available practice. EL-GUIDE owns the course-wide study method, pacing, lookup discipline, answer protocol, source classes, and advancement rules; this packet assumes that orientation and terminology taught in prerequisite modules.

1.2 Controlling records and local state

Course-wide research records own the edition, passage, answer, curriculum, and source decisions; the leaf's module map records this packet's selection and transfer practice. EL-GUIDE owns the corpus, normalization, translation, non-authority, review, and answer conventions that apply here. Claim-local qualifications remain beside the affected material; check received wording against the course-wide passage inventory.

Any installed snapshot is a working study held from release until its exact bytes and outstanding distribution gates receive separate authorization.

CHAPTER 2

References

The following works are the course's controlling corpus and reference aids. Project-composed explanation, translation, analysis, exercises, and models are distinguished from received wording under the convention stated in the Scope and Qualifications appendix. Short source passages are identified so that the learner can verify their wider context. The adjacent edition manifest and passage inventory record exact source roles, checks, access states, and known rights limits.

2.1 Primary corpus

- Catholic Church, *Missale Romanum ex decreto SS. Concilii Tridentini restitutum, Summorum Pontificum cura recognitum*, editio typica (Rome, 1962). A searchable presentation of the edition is hosted by the Holy See's Biblia Clerus project: <https://www.clerus.org/bibliaclerusonline/EN/gmb.htm>.
- A page-image scan of the 1962 typical edition is available through the Church Music Association of America: <https://media.churchmusicassociation.org/pdf/missale62.pdf>. Page images, rather than unsourced transcriptions, should decide doubtful punctuation or spelling.

- The Clementine Vulgate is the principal biblical comparison corpus. The public-domain 1914 edition edited by Michael Hetzenauer and its provenance are described at <https://www.sacredbible.org/vulgate1914/>.

2.2 Grammar and lexicography

- J. H. Allen and J. B. Greenough, *New Latin Grammar for Schools and Colleges* (1903), a donor-declared public-domain reference whose digital locator was not independently consulted during integration: <https://archive.org/details/allengreenoughsn01alle>.
- Charles E. Bennett, *New Latin Grammar*, 1918 revision, Project Gutenberg eBook 15665; public-domain text in the United States: <https://www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/15665>.
- Charlton T. Lewis and Charles Short, *A Latin Dictionary* (1879), searchable transcription: <https://logeion.uchicago.edu/lexidium>.
- Charles du Fresne, sieur du Cange, *Glossarium mediae et infimae latinitatis*, a donor-declared later-vocabulary aid whose digital locator was not independently consulted during integration: <http://ducange.enc.sorbonne.fr/>.

The underlying 1903, 1918, 1879, and 1883–1887 printed works are public domain in the United States. Digital transcriptions and interfaces retain their own terms and are cited as access tools, not relicensed or reproduced wholesale. The 1962 Missal, Scripture, official text, and other received wording retain their own status; see the scope appendix, research records, and final-page rights notice.

Classical reference grammars describe the inherited system but do not by themselves explain every biblical or ecclesiastical development. The advanced volume therefore distinguishes classical baseline, Vulgate usage, later Christian usage, and stable liturgical formula instead of labeling every difference an “exception.”

2.3 Citation convention

Missal passages are cited by liturgical location and text genre rather than by a page number that varies among printings. Biblical texts are cited by book, chapter, and verse. Historical authors are cited by work and section wherever possible. A learner preparing a formal commentary should verify each passage against the edition actually being used and record any variant. These references are not a claim that every historical-linguistic question can be settled by the listed school grammars and dictionary interfaces.

CHAPTER 3

Generation Metadata

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Model: GPT-5-based Codex agent; unexposed: exact model identifier and model qualifiers

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (curriculum architecture, module design, enrichment, source and answer audit, correction, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (whole-curriculum structure audit, shared typesetting and selection correction, rendered-structure regression checks, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (whole-curriculum Part-scoped numbering and rendered contents hierarchy correction, rendered contents-geometry regression checking, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (starter-guide consolidation, module-flow and definition-retrieval revision, stage-boundary assessment correction, catalog and audit records, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

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